

INTERNATIONAL WEIGHTLIFTING FEDERATION
TECHNOLOGY AND INFORMATION SYSTEM (TIS)

LICENSING OF TIS SOFTWARE AND HARDWARE

Request for Proposal (RFP) – 28 September 2026

RFP DOCUMENT

This document establishes a clear, technology-neutral framework under which qualified companies may obtain IWF approval and a licence to provide and operate Technology and Information Systems for weightlifting competitions worldwide. Under the licensing programme, homologation procedures are done on a non-exclusive basis. Therefore, one or more companies can obtain the IWF homologation/licence.

1. Tender Overview

The International Weightlifting Federation (IWF) invites qualified technology providers to submit proposals for the licensing, supply and operation of complete Technology and Information Systems (TIS) for weightlifting competitions.

1.1 Objective

- Establish a consistent IWF licensing framework for TIS suppliers worldwide.
- Ensure software and hardware correctly implement the applicable IWF Technical and Competition Rules & Regulations (TCRR – link [here](#)).
- Protect the integrity, availability, security and traceability of competition data and official results.
- Allow technologically different solutions where equivalent or better sporting and operational outcomes are demonstrated.

1.2 Scope

The licence concerns the complete TIS solution, not only competition software. It may include software, servers/workstations, referee and Jury controls, timing, displays, networks, power protection, printing, video review, interfaces, feeds, monitoring, backup/recovery and other components required by the approved profile.

1.3 Guiding principle

The TIS must provide one controlled and auditable competition state from data intake through final results and archive. Official and public outputs must be traceable to that accepted state.

1.4 Technology neutrality

IWF does not require suppliers to reproduce the architecture of the current IWF TIS. Alternative architectures may be proposed provided competition-critical functions remain safe, controlled and available.

2. Approval and Licensing Model

IWF will apply three linked levels of control. Approval at one level does not replace the others.

Level	Purpose	Result
Technical Homologation / Type Approval	Confirm a precisely identified TIS baseline meets applicable requirements.	Technical approval for defined profile(s).
Supplier Licence	Confirm the legal supplier is accountable and capable of support, training, security, incident response and change control.	Time-limited supplier licence.
Event Readiness Acceptance	Confirm the actual installed system matches the approved baseline and is ready.	Event-specific go/no-go acceptance.

2.1 Profiles

Profile	Scope
M0 – Core Sport Conformance	Complete sport logic, mandatory FOP controls, screens and official documents.
M1 – Licensed Operational Baseline	M0 plus baseline control, audit, interfaces, offline operation, recovery, procedures, training, support and spares.
M2 – Major Event & Broadcast	M1 plus applicable VPT, public/live services, broadcast outputs, enhanced monitoring, high availability and full rehearsal.
M3 – Games & External Integration	M2 plus approved Games/ORIS and programme-specific integrations.
MP – Multi-platform Overlay	Simultaneous platform operation with separation and capacity evidence.

2.2 Licence certificate

The certificate will state supplier, product and exact baseline, approved profiles, capacities, interfaces, critical dependencies, limitations, deviations, validity and surveillance conditions.

3. Minimum Functional Requirements – Competition Lifecycle

The TIS shall support the complete competition lifecycle and apply the effective IWF rules.

Stage	Minimum capability
Data intake	Import and validate athlete, federation/NOC, official, event, venue and record data; stable IDs and error reporting.
VFE / Technical Congress	Corrections, approvals, random lots, grouping, timetable and Technical Official assignments.
Start publication	Approved Start List and controlled distribution/versioning.
Weigh-in	Correct timing, bodyweight, first attempts, 20 kg checks, start numbers, signatures and closed snapshot.
Snatch	Calling order, declarations/changes, 60/120-second timing, referee decisions, records and live outputs.
Break	Controlled Snatch-to-Clean & Jerk transition and synchronized displays.
Clean & Jerk	Calling order, weight changes, 20 kg enforcement, totals, ranks and records.
Review / correction	STOP, Jury, challenge/VPT where applicable, additional attempts, correction, withdrawal and restart.
Results approval	Protocol reconciliation, signatures/status, results, classifications and records.
Ceremony / publication	Medallists, public/broadcast outputs, communications and revised outputs.
Archive	Final dataset, official outputs, logs, revisions, evidence and machine-readable export.

3.1 Core sporting logic

- Snatch followed by Clean & Jerk, maximum three attempts per lift, correct Total calculation.
- Whole-kilogram weights and applicable minimum starting weights.
- Correct calling order, including weight, attempt number, previous-attempt sequence and start number.
- Permitted weight changes, final-call and consecutive-attempt rules.
- Withdrawals, no-lift/no-Total conditions, disqualification and additional attempts.
- Material corrections recalculate affected rankings, records and outputs.

4. Timing, Officiating and Outputs

4.1 Timing

- Authoritative electronic countdown in one-second increments, configurable up to at least 15 minutes.
- Automatic 60- and 120-second attempt clocks and applicable introduction/break countdowns.
- Correct start, stop, restart and STOP behaviour according to the rules.
- All connected displays use the same authoritative time state within the approved tolerance.
- Time corrections are authorised, recorded and auditable.

4.2 Referee and Jury

- Three independent referee control boxes with white/red decisions and required indicators.
- Correct majority/Down signal, reminder and reversal-window behaviour.
- Jury visibility of individual referee decisions before public reveal.
- Support for approved three- and five-member Jury configurations.
- Individual Jury decision controls and protected independence between members.
- Material decisions and actions are attributable and time-stamped.

4.3 Screens and live presentation

At minimum: system health, event setup, VFE, lots/groups/timetable, weigh-in, Chief Marshal, timekeeper, competition supervisor, referee monitoring, Jury control, attempt boards, scoreboards, RTDS/warm-up, STOP, records, results and other approved states.

4.4 Official outputs

At minimum: Start Lists, Start List Package, Weigh-in List, Athlete's Cards, Empty Protocol, Manual Protocol, Protocol, Results, Team Classification/Placing, Records, Final Results Package, Results Book where applicable, machine-readable export, distribution records and final evidence/archive.

Paper, PDF and machine-readable outputs are delivery channels; none may become an undocumented alternative source of sporting truth.

5. Hardware and Field-of-Play Requirements

The supplier shall provide or support the complete hardware environment necessary for the claimed profile. Equivalent integrated or virtualised designs may be accepted where safety, independence, visibility and fallback are preserved.

Component	Minimum requirement
Servers / control compute	Controlled capacity for authoritative state and approved services, with spare/recovery path.
Operator stations	Dedicated, role-controlled competition administration and operation positions.
Database / storage	Protected authoritative storage, backup and tested recovery.
Referee controls	Three independent red/white referee control devices.

Jury controls	Individual devices for applicable Jury members plus President controls.
Timing	Authoritative timer/controller with approved displays and audio.
Attempt boards	Competition and warm-up presentation with mandatory athlete/attempt/weight/clock/decision data.
Scoreboards / RTDS	Real-time competition and warm-up displays with correct ranking and state.
VPT	Approved cameras, recording/replay and Jury output for events requiring VPT.
Network	Documented, segmented, monitored event network with common time.
Public / broadcast gateways	Controlled read-only path from accepted state to approved consumers.
Printing	Reliable official documents with fallback.
UPS / protected power	Protection and approved autonomy for critical equipment.
Monitoring / logging	Health, service, device, storage, time and state-state monitoring.
Spares / recovery media	Rapidly deployable replacements for critical equipment families.
FOP installation	Safe, labelled cabling and equipment placement without obstruction or sightline conflicts.

5.1 Hardware inventory

For each licensed event, the supplier shall maintain make/model, quantity, serial or asset ID, firmware, location, connections, power source, owner, health status, spare path and approved deviations.

6. Software, Data and Interfaces

6.1 Software

- Implement the effective IWF rule pack and support controlled updates.
- Competition-critical functions shall not depend on unavailable internet, licence-server or payment services.
- Exact production version, configuration, database schema, rule pack and relevant assets shall be identifiable and reproducible.
- Installation and rollback shall be documented and repeatable.
- Automatic updates shall not occur during an event freeze unless approved.

6.2 Data integrity and authoritative state

- Every sporting fact shall have one declared authoritative owner.
- Derived screens, feeds, documents and caches shall be traceable to the accepted state.
- Corrections shall be authorised, atomic, attributable and propagated.
- Duplicate, lost, conflicting or out-of-order transactions shall be prevented or detected.
- A complete machine-readable event export shall be available to IWF.

6.3 Interfaces

Material interfaces shall document producer/consumer, purpose, version, schema/field mapping, identifiers, status/null rules, sequencing/revision, time source, latency, authentication, acknowledgement, retry/reconnect, monitoring and fallback.

6.4 Third-party dependencies

All third-party software, libraries, services, licences and hardware necessary for operation shall be declared, including version, ownership, support status and cloud/public-internet dependency.

7. Security, Resilience and Business Continuity

7.1 Security

- Least-privilege access by role and device identity.
- Separation of competition, device, public/display, database and management functions where applicable.
- Protection of credentials, secrets and data in transit/at rest where required.
- Controlled remote support, removable media and patch/deployment processes.
- Tamper-resistant audit sufficient to reconstruct material actions.
- No public or anonymous path may write authoritative competition state.

7.2 Offline operation

Core competition, officiating, timing, local displays and local official documents shall remain usable during loss of public internet or cloud connectivity.

7.3 Backup and recovery

- Protected backup copies of data, configuration, rules, assets and audit.
- Timed restoration demonstrating the approved recovery objective.
- Defined promotion, split-brain prevention, failback and reconciliation where redundancy is claimed.
- Cold-start and rollback procedures using controlled recovery media.

7.4 Manual continuity

A manual Protocol and rehearsed manual-continuity procedure shall remain available. Staff shall know when to continue, when to STOP and how to reconcile manual records with the electronic state.

7.5 Monitoring

Actionable monitoring shall cover critical services, devices, timing, storage, network and state-state conditions, with clear escalation responsibilities.

8. Supplier Eligibility and Responsibilities

8.1 Minimum supplier requirements

- Legally established entity able to contract with IWF.
- Relevant experience delivering competition scoring/results or comparable mission-critical systems.
- Ability to accept end-to-end responsibility for the complete system and declared third-party components.
- Qualified technical, competition-operations and support personnel.
- International training, event support and incident-response capability.
- Ability to maintain the approved baseline for the licence period.

8.2 Supplier responsibilities

- Provide accurate product and hardware baseline.
- Provide complete technical submission and evidence package.
- Make the declared system available for IWF testing and demonstrations.
- Correct deficiencies and complete regression testing when required.
- Notify IWF of material product, security, hardware, interface or rule-logic changes.
- Maintain qualified support personnel and appropriate spares.
- Protect IWF, athlete and event information and comply with applicable data-protection requirements.

8.3 IWF responsibilities

- Define applicable rules, profiles and event requirements.
- Provide the controlled assessment process.
- Appoint/designate the assessment authority and independent assessors where required.
- Review evidence, conduct tests and issue the licensing decision.
- Maintain the official register of approved suppliers/products and licence status.

9. Tender Submission Requirements

A proposal shall be submitted as one coherent package. IWF may request clarification but is not obliged to allow material changes after the submission deadline.

Section	Supplier submission
A. Company	Legal name, registration, ownership/contact details, experience and references.
B. Product	Product name, architecture, supported profiles, capacities, deployment model and limitations.
C. Software	Modules, versions, rule-pack approach, database, interfaces, deployment and update model.
D. Hardware	Equipment list, specifications, quantities, spares and lifecycle/support information.
E. Competition functionality	Lifecycle, officiating, timing, displays, outputs, results and archive.
F. Security & resilience	Security architecture, access, offline operation, backup, recovery, failover and continuity.
G. Integration	Interfaces, APIs/feeds, public/broadcast and Games/ORIS integrations.
H. Operations	Staffing, training, manuals, event support, escalation and incident response.
I. Homologation	Test environment, evidence package, demonstration plan and FAT/SAT readiness.
J. Commercial	Licence, implementation, equipment, support/maintenance, optional services and recurring charges.
K. Legal	IP/licensing, warranties, liability, confidentiality, data protection, subcontractors and termination.
L. Compliance matrix	Clear response to this tender and the applicable IWF assessment.

9.1 Mandatory declarations

- Acceptance of the IWF TCRR as the controlling sporting rules.
- Identification of all material limitations and dependencies.
- Ability to reproduce the tested system from controlled installation material.
- Offline operation and tested recovery for the claimed profile.
- No automatic licensing mechanism that can interrupt an active competition.

10. Evaluation and Homologation Process

The tender evaluation and technical homologation are evidence-based. The supplier may demonstrate and explain its system, but cannot be the sole assessor of its own approval.

Stage	Activity	Outcome
1. Administrative review	Completeness, eligibility and declarations.	Accepted / clarification / excluded.
2. Technical review	Architecture, functionality, hardware, interfaces, security and resilience.	Technical assessment report.
3. Scope confirmation	Freeze baseline, profile, capacity, dependencies and test plan.	Approved scope/test plan.
4. FAT	Controlled normal, edge, security, capacity and failure testing.	Signed results and findings.
5. Corrective action	Resolve deficiencies and provide regression evidence.	Closed findings or limitations.

6. Operational validation	Representative event tempo with operators, officials, displays, feeds and recovery.	Validation report.
7. Homologation decision	Review requirements, hard gates, evidence and findings.	Approved / limited / pilot / re-test / rejected.
8. Supplier licence	Complete legal and operational conditions.	Licence and register entry.
9. Event SAT	Check actual installation against approved baseline.	Event readiness acceptance.
10. Surveillance	Review incidents, changes, support and expiry.	Renew / restrict / suspend / withdraw / re-homologate.

10.1 Evidence

Evidence shall be attributable to a specific baseline and test. Screenshots alone are insufficient where logs, physical inspection or live behaviour are necessary.

11. Approval Criteria and Hard Gates

The following nine hard gates protect sporting correctness, integrity, safety, continuity and evidence. A failure or unresolved blocking condition prevents approval.

Gate	Subject	Blocking condition
HG-01	Sport rules & result correctness	Incorrect sporting fact, rank, medal, record or rule-critical transition.
HG-02	Authoritative state & data integrity	Split, duplicated, lost or silently overwritten accepted state.
HG-03	Timing & adjudication safety	Unsafe or ambiguous timing, decision, Down signal or restart.
HG-04	Correction & audit	Unauthorised, partial, untraceable or unreconciled correction.
HG-05	Continuity & recovery	Uncontrolled loss of competition or unverified recovery.
HG-06	Security & least privilege	Uncontrolled privilege, public write path or material compromise.
HG-07	Output parity & publication	Contradictory outputs or untraceable final publication.
HG-08	Baseline reproducibility	Unknown tested version, missing evidence or irreproducible installation.
HG-09	FOP readiness & safety	Missing critical equipment, unsafe installation or unresolved obstruction.

11.1 Decision rules

- All applicable mandatory requirements and tests must be disposed of.
- Applicable TCRR requirements and hard gates must pass.
- No open Critical finding may remain.
- Traceability from requirement to evidence and test must be complete.
- Successful FAT, recovery and operational validation are required for the claimed profile.
- Partial is not Pass.

IWF may approve with explicit profile limitations where permitted, but a limitation cannot change an IWF sport rule or bypass a hard gate.

12. Licence Conditions, Change Control and Event Deployment

12.1 Licence validity

The IWF licence shall be valid for a four-year period. The certificate will state supplier, product/baseline, profiles, capacities, limitations, deviations, validity and surveillance conditions. The final contract shall state the exact licence duration and renewal conditions.

12.2 Change control

Change	Required action
Editorial / non-functional	Controlled update and review.
Minor cosmetic	Supplier assessment and IWF notification where applicable.
Significant – OS/database/firmware/interface/security/workflow/hardware	Impact assessment and approved regression/delta test.
Major – competition logic/timing/adjudication/records/state/failover	Re-homologation before event use.
Emergency security/stability correction	Named approval, backup, rollback, targeted test and retrospective evidence.

12.3 Event deployment

- Only the approved baseline and event configuration may be used.
- Actual hardware, software, network, power, displays, spares and staffing must match the approved event design.
- Dress rehearsal and failure/recovery test shall be completed before readiness sign-off.
- Substitutions require approved deviation or delta testing before use.

12.4 Support and incidents

- Defined escalation contacts and event support.
- Critical incidents documented, contained, investigated and reported.
- Serious incidents, unauthorised changes, false evidence, unsupported baselines or material security compromise may lead to restriction, suspension or withdrawal.

12.5 Intellectual property

The supplier retains its intellectual property except where otherwise agreed. IWF shall receive the rights, documentation, exports, interfaces and operational access necessary to use, verify, archive and maintain the approved system and competition records. Final contractual wording will be agreed with the selected supplier.

13. Commercial and Contractual Conditions

The Licensing Fee for the four-year period is of US\$ 20'000, payable on an annual basis of US\$ 5'000 per year.

14. Submission Deadline

All submissions must be delivered electronically in PDF format in English language, no later than:

Deadline: **Saturday, 24 October 2026**
 Email: **iwf@iwf.sport**
 Subject line: **IWF TIS RFP – Proposals**